

Daily Market Summary

July 23, 2026

Market Tone — Today's Session

A recap of how the market traded today — not a forecast.

Today: -0.44 → Bearish

Trend (5-day EMA): -0.16 → Slightly Bearish — smoothed, the readable day-over-day signal.

Component	Weight	Score
Market data	70%	-0.57
News headlines	20%	+0.00
Reddit (disabled)	0%	-0.01
Fed (rate expectations)	10%	-0.37

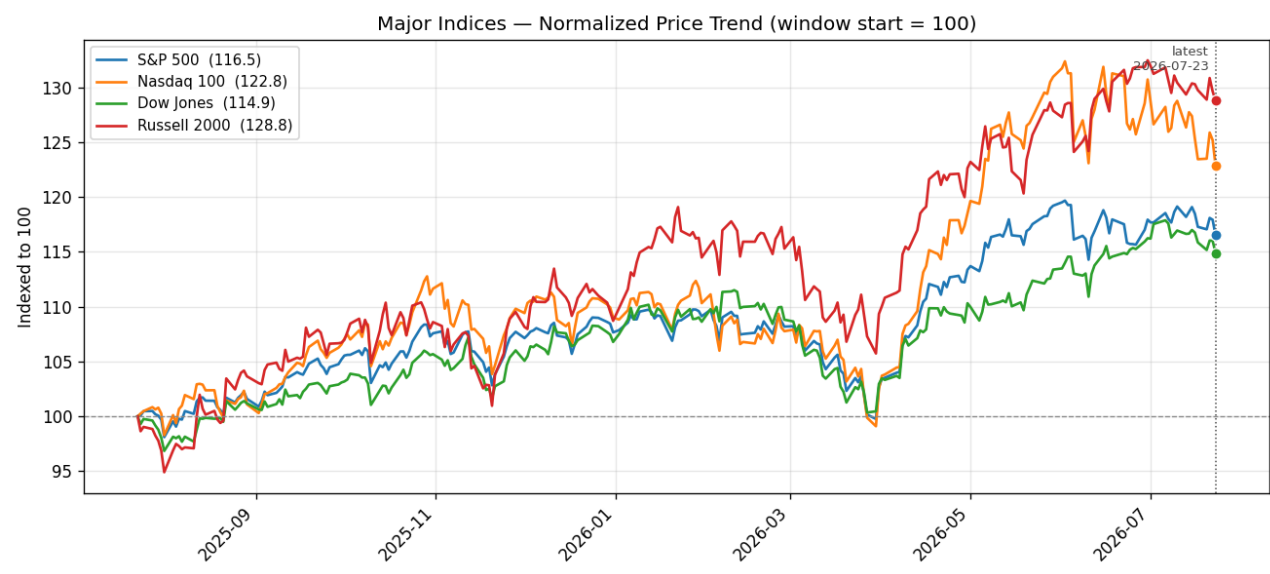
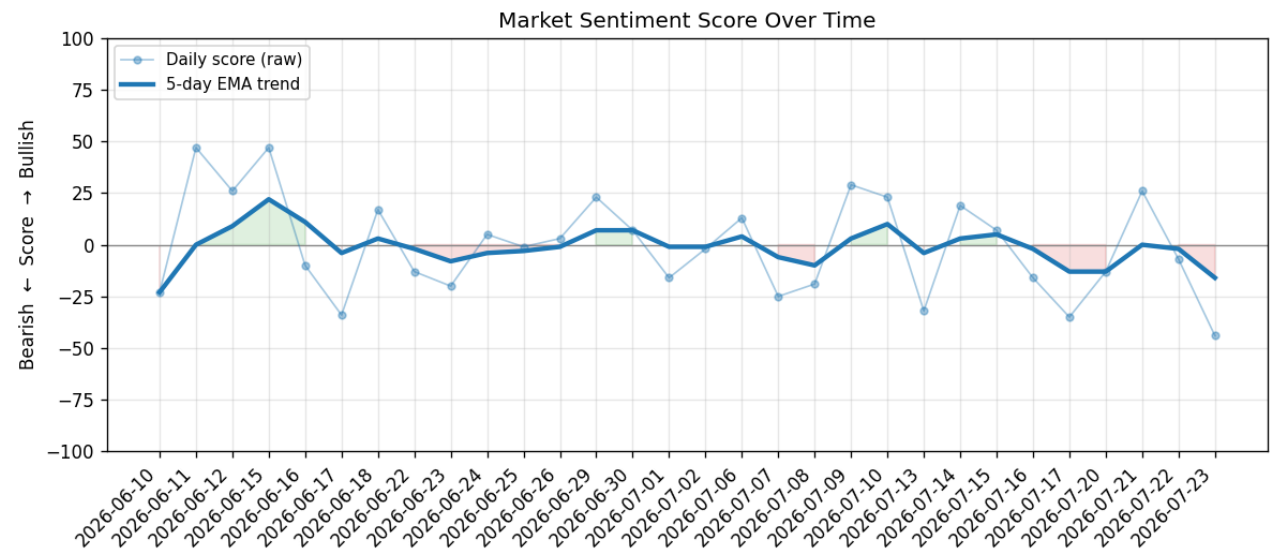
Equities fell with Nasdaq -1.9%, S&P 500 -1.2%, VIX +12.4%. Sector breadth: 4/11 sectors up. 10Y yield +1.0%. News headlines read neutral. Fed-policy expectations tightened (13-Week T-Bill Yield +5.5bp). Today's overall market tone: Bearish. (news scored with finbert)

Standout headlines

Most bullish (+0.89) — JPMorgan report finds dramatic jump in AI-themed ETFs — despite rough quarter

Most bearish (-0.83) — Alphabet’s massive profit growth is ‘illusory’, as SpaceX and Anthropic help mask a historic cash drain

Trend Charts



Sector Watch (AI Stack)

Score describes the day: driven by the session move (70%), with breadth (avg % of the 20/50-day MAs the basket trades above, 15%) and news (15%) for texture. Relative strength (vs the Nasdaq for tech baskets, the S&P for the rest) is shown as a context column but doesn't drive the label. Sorted strongest→weakest.

Sector	Move	Rel. Str.	Breadth	News	Overall
Pharma / Healthcare	+1.42%	+2.63% vs S&P	81%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.64)
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	+0.64%	+2.51% vs Nasdaq	50%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.35)
Networking / Interconnect	+0.33%	+2.20% vs Nasdaq	36%	Slightly Bullish	Slightly Bullish (+0.18)
Banking	-0.92%	+0.29% vs S&P	75%	Slightly Bearish	Bearish (-0.35)
Semiconductors / Compute	-1.22%	+0.65% vs Nasdaq	35%	Bullish	Bearish (-0.49)
Consumer	-1.02%	+0.19% vs S&P	12%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.55)
SaaS	-2.48%	-0.61% vs Nasdaq	28%	Slightly Bullish	Bearish (-0.83)
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	-3.36%	-1.49% vs Nasdaq	7%	Slightly Bearish	Bearish (-0.91)

Positioning & Regime

Was today bullish or bearish, read through positioning: out-of-the-money put/call volume (hedging vs chasing, daily) and short %-of-float (squeeze fuel; exchange data, biweekly) explain the character of the day's move — squeeze rebound, hedged advance, conviction selling. **Under evaluation** — logged daily, drives no scores.

Basket	OTM P/C	Short Flt	Day	Today's Read
Banking	1.94	0.0%	-0.92%	Bearish — orderly decline; positioning unremarkable
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	1.48	5.3%	+0.64%	Bullish — advance, but heavily hedged — protection still bid
Consumer	0.63	1.9%	-1.02%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Networking / Interconnect	0.61	4.3%	+0.33%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Semiconductors / Compute	0.55	2.5%	-1.22%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Pharma / Healthcare	0.41	1.7%	+1.43%	Bullish — complacent advance — few hedges or shorts in place

SaaS	0.38	5.5%	-2.48%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	0.32	1.6%	-3.36%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
All tracked	0.53	2.4%	-0.91%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked

Top Gainers

Company	Price	% Change
NovoCure Limited (NVCR)	19.99	+28.39%
Cleveland-Cliffs Inc. (CLF)	10.96	+15.98%
Medpace Holdings, Inc. (MEDP)	605.82	+14.71%
EquipmentShare.com Inc (EQPT)	19.40	+11.88%
Imax Corporation (IMAX)	43.96	+11.86%

Top News

Trump rolls out a new wave of tariffs. Here are the latest rates. — MarketWatch (Top)

President Donald Trump and U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer are making a fresh move with tariffs on Thursday.

Stocks making the biggest moves after hours: Intel, AMD, Boston Beer, Deckers & more — CNBC (Finance)

These are the stocks posting the largest moves after the bell.

Intel forecast crushes estimates as AI boom boosts chip demand; shares jump — Investing.com

Tesla sees a \$214 billion wipeout as investors pan Elon Musk’s plan to spend ‘as fast as we can’ — MarketWatch (Top)

Tesla’s stock has its worst drop in a year after the company’s earnings call leaves Wall Street with more questions than answers.

Odds of Federal Reserve rate hike surge as oil prices rip higher — CNBC (Finance)

Investors are increasingly readying for the Federal Reserve to hike interest rates in September.

Market Snapshot

Major Indices

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
S&P 500	7,408.30	-90.66	-1.21%
Nasdaq 100	28,454.81	-543.29	-1.87%
Dow Jones	51,711.65	-506.93	-0.97%
Russell 2000	2,940.16	-19.78	-0.67%
VIX	18.70	+2.06	+12.38%

Key Stocks

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Nvidia	208.76	-3.30	-1.56%
Microsoft	381.58	-8.76	-2.24%
AMD	539.69	-12.64	-2.29%
Meta	606.10	-21.07	-3.36%
Alphabet	318.34	-23.57	-6.89%
Broadcom	392.47	-4.34	-1.09%
Micron	990.21	+30.73	+3.20%
Intel	100.23	-2.39	-2.33%
SanDisk	1,610.33	+11.06	+0.69%
Coherent	313.22	+1.03	+0.33%
Amazon	233.66	-11.19	-4.57%
Apple	321.66	-4.23	-1.30%
Arm	283.04	-0.36	-0.13%

Commodities & Crypto

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Gold	4,052.30	-99.60	-2.40%
Crude Oil	92.36	+5.53	+6.37%
Bitcoin	65,061.32	-982.84	-1.49%

FX Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
EUR/USD	1.14	-0.00	-0.24%
USD/JPY	163.82	+0.73	+0.45%
GBP/USD	1.33	-0.01	-0.44%

Interest Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
10Y Treasury Yield	4.70	+0.05	+0.99%
13-Week T-Bill Yield	3.80	+0.06	+1.47%

Analyst Summary

Market Overview

U.S. equities tumbled Thursday as a fresh wave of tariff announcements and surging oil prices rattled investor confidence. The S&P 500 dropped 1.21%, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq 100 fell 1.87%, led by steep losses in mega-cap technology stocks. The VIX volatility index surged 12.38% to 18.70, reflecting growing hedging demand as traders brace for potential turbulence ahead.

President Trump's announcement of new tariffs covering 60 trade partners weighed on sentiment, reviving concerns about global trade friction and inflationary pressures. Compounding the anxiety, crude oil spiked 6.37% to \$92.36 per barrel, prompting market chatter that the Federal Reserve might reconsider its easing path. Some reports noted odds of a rate hike have surged, a dramatic reversal that pushed the 10-year Treasury yield up 5 basis points to 4.70%.

Technology Sector Under Pressure

The day's narrative was dominated by tech weakness, particularly among hyperscalers and cloud infrastructure names. Alphabet cratered 6.89% following reports that massive profit growth is "illusory," with analyses pointing to SpaceX and Anthropic investments masking underlying cash drain concerns. Amazon fell 4.57%, Meta dropped 3.36%, and Microsoft declined 2.24%. The Hyperscalers & Neoclouds sector fell 3.4% with extremely thin breadth (7%), and notably low put/call ratios (0.32) suggest the selloff occurred without panic hedging—potentially signaling capitulation or complacency.

A bright spot emerged in memory chips: **Micron surged 3.20%**, helping the Memory sector gain 0.64% despite broader semiconductor weakness. Intel dominated after-hours headlines with a forecast that "crushes estimates," citing unprecedented AI-driven chip demand and the fastest sales growth in nearly 15 years.

Standout Gainers and Defensive Rotation

Outside tech, defensive and opportunistic plays outperformed. **NovoCure Limited (NVCR)** led all gainers, soaring 28.39%, while **Cleveland-Cliffs (CLF)** jumped 15.98% on commodity strength. **Medpace Holdings (MEDP)** rallied 14.71%, part of a broader healthcare sector advance (+1.42%) that showed strong breadth (81%) and bullish sentiment. The Pharma/Healthcare sector's low put/call ratio (0.41) suggests a complacent rally with minimal hedging.

Gold fell 2.40% despite hedge-fund manager John Paulson calling it a "long-term bull market," likely pressured by rising real yields and a stronger dollar (USD/JPY +0.45%). Bitcoin declined 1.49%, tracking risk-off flows.